

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6 ♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 5 ♣

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♥

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

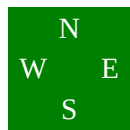
♠ J 7 6 2
♥ 10 7 4 3
♦ 9 5
♣ Q J 6

♠ A K Q 9 5 3

♥ A

♦ A K 4

♣ A K 2



♠ 4

♥ J 9 5 2

♦ Q J 10 6 3

♣ 10 8 4

♠ 10 8

♥ K Q 8 6

♦ 8 7 2

♣ 9 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			

6 ♠ by North

going to lose a trump in any case. Play dummy's ♥ K Q, discarding your two minor losers. Ruff a ♥ to return to your hand, pull trumps and claim.

As you can see you have a trump loser in addition to the small ♦ and ♣. By establishing the ♠ entry to dummy you can discard the ♦ and ♣.

You can see how it works if the trump suit DID split 3-2 as you would expect it to do. Even without a trump loser you will still go down 1 if you cannot take two discards on dummy's ♥s.

So you give up a trump trick and gain two ♥ tricks in return. What a deal.

North is to play 6 ♠. East leads the ♦ Q.

Losers: ♠ = 0 or 1 ♥ = 0 ♦ = 1 ♣ = 1 Total = 2 or 3

You probably do not have a trump loser because they will probably split 3-2. Still, a 4-1 split is certainly not out of the question.

But those two minor suit losers are definite **UNLESS** you can somehow get to dummy's ♥ K Q. Can you?

Yes you can get to dummy, in the trump suit. Win the opening ♦ lead. Unblock the ♥ A before touching trumps. Play a **SMALL** trump toward dummy. A defender will surely take his ♠ J here, and play another ♦. Win that trick and play another small ♠. This one will get you into dummy. And by the way, East discards a ♦ so it turns out you were

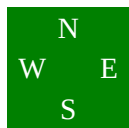
Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q
 ♥ 6 4 3
 ♦ 8 7 4 2
 ♣ 6 5 3 2

♠ 7 5 4 2
 ♥ K 10 5 2
 ♦ K J 9 3
 ♣ 10



♠ K 9
 ♥ A J 9
 ♦ 6
 ♣ A K Q J 9 8 7

♠ J 10 8 6 3
 ♥ Q 8 7
 ♦ A Q 10 5
 ♣ 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	Pass
1NT	Pass	3 ♣	Pass
4 ♣	Pass	5 ♣	
All Pass			
5 ♣ by East			

East is to play 5 ♣. South leads the ♠ J.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 3

You have no way to get rid of the Fast ♦ loser, but you might be able to eliminate one of the ♥ losers. If North holds either ♥ K 10 x or ♥ Q 10 x then a Deep Finesse would save one loser.

Should you pull trumps right away?

No, you cannot pull trumps yet. For the Deep Finesse to work you must lead twice from dummy. The only way to get into dummy twice is in the ♠ suit and one of those times must be at trick 1.

Win the first trick with dummy's ♠ Q and play a ♥ to your ♥ 9. Assume South wins with the ♥ K or ♥ Q, and plays another ♠.

In dummy for the last time, play a ♥ to your ♥ J and hope it wins.

As you can see, you must play ♥s twice from dummy in order to take the two finesses.

So you couldn't pull that one round of trumps because you couldn't waste either visit to dummy for anything other than the ♥ finesses.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 8 4

♥ 4

♦ K Q 8 7 3

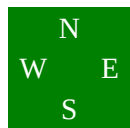
♣ 9 8 6

♠ 7 5 2

♥ 8 6

♦ A 9 4

♣ K Q J 10 2



♠ J 10 6

♥ Q J 10 2

♦ J 10 5 2

♣ 7 4

♠ K Q 3

♥ A K 9 7 5 3

♦ 6

♣ A 5 3

West	North	East	South
------	-------	------	-------

Pass

2♣

Pass

1♥

Pass

4♥

3♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

them to force out East's ♥Q. You still have a trump left to stop their ♦s, and as soon as you get the lead you can now run dummy's ♣ suit safely.

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♦K.

Losers: ♠ = 2 ♥ = 1 or 2 ♦ = 0 ♣ = 0 Total = 3 or 4

In fact if trumps split 5-0 you could have 3 losers in the suit and a disaster. So we won't worry about that possibility. Since the most likely scenario is a 3-2 split you should plan on taking the ♥ A K, then driving out their master trump so you can run dummy's ♣s without somebody ruffing in.

Bad news. West discards a ♦ on the second ♥ lead. Time for a change in plans?

Actually, no. East has 2 master trumps at this point but you still have ♥ 9 7 5 3. So use one of your little ones to drive out East's ♥J. He will probably force you to ruff a ♦, leaving you with ♥ 9 7. Use one of

Suppose you had not driven out both of East's high trumps.

He would have ruffed the third ♣, before you could discard a ♠ loser from your hand. You would lose two trumps and two ♠s.